



▲ MAUSER MODEL 1896

Date	1896
Origin	Germany
Barrel	29¼in (74cm)
Caliber	6.5 × 55mm

Waffenfabrik Mauser began exporting rifles to China in 1875; then came the Mauser-Koka, for Serbia; the Belgian M1889; the Turkish M1890; the Argentine M1891; and the Spanish M1893. The world's armies seemed to be beating a path to Mauser's door. Mauser began manufacturing the Model 1896 for Sweden in 1895. Licensed Swedish production of the rifle continued until 1944.

Cleaning rod

▼ ARISAKA MEIJI 30

Date	1897
Origin	Japan
Barrel	31½in (79.8cm)
Caliber	6.5 × 50mm

At the conclusion of its war with China in 1895, the Japanese Army decided to adopt a modern rifle in a small caliber. Designed by Colonel Nariakira Arisaka, this gun was chambered for a 6.5mm semi-rimmed round and used a turning bolt of the Mauser pattern with forward-locking lugs. It came into service in the 30th year of the Emperor Meiji.



Leaf-type rear sight

FULL VIEW

▼ MAUSER MODEL 1898

Date	1898
Origin	Germany
Barrel	29¼in (74cm)
Caliber	7.92 × 57mm

By the time of the *Gewehr* (rifle) 98, Mauser had solved virtually every problem known to beset the bolt-action magazine rifle. It added a third rear-locking lug to reinforce the two forward-mounted lugs, as well as improving gas sealing and refining the magazine. If the rifle had a fault, it lay in the design of its bolt handle, which projected outward and tended to catch on clothing.



Sling



Foresight

Cleaning rod

◀ MAUSER MODEL 1893

Date	1900
Origin	Germany
Barrel	29¼in (74cm)
Caliber	7 × 57mm

The Mauser 1893 was the seminal Spanish Mauser rifle of the late 1800s. Such was its effectiveness during the Spanish–American War that it pushed the US toward development of the Springfield rifle (below). The 1893 was fed from a five-round integral box magazine. The example shown here was manufactured in 1900.



Barrel band

Bayonet lug

◀ SPRINGFIELD MODEL 1903

Date	1903
Origin	US
Barrel	24in (61cm)
Caliber	.30in-03

Impressed by the Mauser rifles US troops encountered during the war against Spain, the United States Ordnance Department looked to replace its Krag rifles (see pp.62–63). Negotiating a license to build a Mauser design of its own, the result was the .30in Rifle, Magazine, M1903. The example shown here has an experimental 25-round magazine.